



STATUS REPORT

Ethiopia: status report

Edition of 2026-08-16 · 83 systems and instruments tracked, 4 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-14 from the Data Landscapers source base, from [outputs/reports/ETH/ledger.csv](#) (83 systems and instruments, 4 of them **Not held**). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

Status values. *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

Summary of position

Fayda, the national digital identity, is the flagship deployment of an open-source platform, [authenticates up to 4m times a day across more than 150 agencies](#), was [incorporated on 2026-08-04 as a state-owned enterprise](#), [Faydaverse](#), under [Ethiopian Investment Holdings](#), and is now being exported to Mozambique and Zambia.

The Personal Data Protection Proclamation has been in force since July 2024, its secondary directives remain unissued, [its regulator has yet to enforce](#), and no separately identifiable money is appropriated for the job. The one-stop service platform's own regional executives [told federal management in July](#) that services are being onboarded before their underlying systems are digitised, and the interoperability layer that would fix it was approved by a prime-ministerial board in the same meeting that diagnosed its absence.

Four things a reader would look for are not established at all, among them the secondary directives under that law and any audit of digital spending.

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Ethio Telecom network	IMPLEMENTED ↗	FY2025/26 close: data 31.1% of revenue against voice 23.5%
Network expansion contracts from MWC 2026	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Ethio Telecom-ZTE progress review 2026-08-10: 879 sites completed under the ZTE programme

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Safaricom Ethiopia second network	IMPLEMENTED ↗	14.7m 90-day active customers at 2026-06-30, against an EBITDA-positive target of March 2027
Safaricom regional fibre deployment	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Afdera-Mekelle build from 2025-08-02
teleStream and Zero-Touch Broadband	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2026-02-23
Third mobile network operator licence	NOT HELD	—

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Wingu Cloud Exchange in-country cloud	IMPLEMENTED ↗	In-country cloud live 2026-04-01

Energy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Bitdeer Oromia bitcoin-mining site	IMPLEMENTED ↗	40 MW complete 2026-01-12
Ethio Telecom Green Operator renewable network programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	39.72 MW of installed solar at 2026-08-04, up 12.72 MW over the financial year

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
INSA cybersecurity and sovereign-cloud foundations	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Named in Digital Ethiopia 2030, 2025-12-21

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Telecommunications Licensing Directive 792/2021	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Issued July 2021 under Proclamation 1148/2019

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Telecom liberalisation	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Monopoly ended 2021; one new full licensee since

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Horizon Fiber terrestrial corridor	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Memorandum became binding 2026-02-05

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Universal Access Fund levy	IMPLEMENTED ↗	1.5% of revenue levied from 2026-03-01

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Smartphone affordability financing	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Bank financing deals signed 2026-07-17

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Ethio Telecom and Huawei enterprise stack	PLANNED ↗	Scoping discussions reported 2026-07-17
Inspur and Shandong data-centre track	PLANNED ↗	Track opened 2026-07-16

India activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
RailTel data-centre build	PLANNED ↗	Announced 2026-01-09

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Licensing framework for LEO satellite operators	IMPLEMENTED, AS A GENERAL SATELLITE CLASS LICENCE RATHER THAN A LEO-SPECIFIC FRAMEWORK ↗	GMPCS landing-right class licence set in Directive 792/2021 (2021-07)

Ethiopia liberalised telecoms in 2021 and the market is still two operators. Ethio Telecom reports [99.8% coverage on 90.1m subscribers and revenue of 215.8bn Birr](#) in FY2025/26. At the financial-year close on 2026-06-30, [data and internet services were 31.1% of that revenue against mobile voice at 23.5%](#), on the operator's own figures the first year in which voice was not the largest earner, with operating profit of 92.9bn Birr. [Directive 792/2021](#) has set the route since July 2021 — a unified telecommunications service licence awarded by competitive bidding and valid fifteen years.

The second operator's development-finance backers have been diluted. [A funding round restricted to the Vodacom family lifted Safaricom's holding to 54.1% in March 2026](#) from 51.67% a year earlier, cutting Sumitomo to 23.5%, British International Investment to 9.5% and the IFC to 6.81%, with a right to reacquire the 2.78%. The parent puts funding at KES 345.7bn (US\$2.672bn) by 2026-06-30, including the US\$850m licence fee, against 14.7m 90-day active customers and an EBITDA-positive target of March 2027.

The Horizon Fiber corridor moved from a December 2024 memorandum to a [binding agreement in February 2026](#) — Ethio Telecom, Djibouti Telecom and Sudatel linking Djibouti's subsea landings through Ethiopia to Sudan's.

Of the MWC 2026 network-expansion contracts, [Ethio Telecom and ZTE reported 879 sites completed by 10 August 2026](#), taking 4G population coverage to 92% across ZTE's own network footprint, with 124 new sites and 272 refarming sites still to come; that figure is not reconciled against the 95.5% national 4G coverage claimed at signature.

The same directive's class-licence schedule carries a [landing right for satellite services delivered without infrastructure in the country](#), so a low-earth-orbit operator has a route to apply for; the regulator denied in July 2025 that any discussions with one had taken place, and no authorisation is on record.

Compute is arriving on cheap power and on Chinese and Indian partnerships.

Site power is what makes rural coverage expensive. Ethio Telecom reported [39.72 MW of installed solar \(2026-08-04\) across 190 fully solar-powered sites and 867 hybrid solar-and-battery systems](#), 12.72 MW of it added over the last financial year, with diesel generator running time down by up to 40% — its own unaudited figures.

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
EthSwitch national switch	IMPLEMENTED ↗	M-PESA integrated 2025-10-01
National data exchange platform	PLANNED ↗	Approved by a prime-ministerial board 2026-07-25

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Biometric enrolment kits for banks	IMPLEMENTED ↗	2,000 kits to 31 banks (2025-11)
Ethio Telecom as identity enrolment channel	IMPLEMENTED ↗	69% of all national registrations (2026-07)
Fayda national digital identity	IMPLEMENTED ↗	47.8m identities issued (2026-07-27)
Faydaverse digital public infrastructure enterprise	IMPLEMENTED, AS A STATE-OWNED ENTERPRISE UNDER ETHIOPIAN INVESTMENT HOLDINGS ↗	Inaugurated as a state-owned enterprise 2026-08-04
Safaricom and Africom identity registration joint venture	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Lots 3 and 4 awarded 2026-07-06

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
EthioPay national instant payment system	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2026-02-13
EthSwitch and Mastercard international acceptance	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Live 2025-11-30
M-PESA Ethiopia	IMPLEMENTED ↗	2.58m monthly active users in the quarter to June 2026
M-PESA Ethiopia cardless ATM withdrawals	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched with Bank of Abyssinia 2026-08-11
M-PESA LeHulum telco-agnostic wallet	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2025-12-02
Mandatory Fayda integration with bank accounts	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Harmonisation deadline 2026-03-30
Prepaid electricity purchase in the mobile wallet	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Live 2026-07-29
Regional tax payment through the mobile wallet	IMPLEMENTED ↗	First authority live 2026-07-28
Telebirr mobile money	IMPLEMENTED ↗	4.19tn Birr transacted in FY2025/26

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
America First Global Health Strategy memorandum of understanding	IMPLEMENTED, EXPRESSLY NOT AN INTERNATIONAL AGREEMENT ↗	Signed 2025-12-23 for activities running 2026-04-01 to 2030-12-31
DHIS2 national health information system	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Maturity 2.81 of 5 against a 4.09 target (2026-04)
Donor-funded health and surveillance data systems	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Livestock and zoonotic surveillance suspended (2025)
eCHIS community health information system	IMPLEMENTED ↗	In use by about 40,000 health extension workers
Livestock Information System	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Live 2026-07-29

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Electronic Government Procurement (e-GP) system	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Credited in the EFY 2017 federal audit report presented 2026-07-06
Identity integration with tax administration	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Integrated 2023-12
MESOB unified public-service platform	IMPLEMENTED ↗	185 services at launch, 2026-06-20
Unmanned smart police station	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Opened 2026-03-22

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Digital Government Strategy and Enterprise Architecture 2024-2029	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Published 2024-07-11
National Digital Payments Strategy 2026-2030	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Published 2025-12-09

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Ethiopian eGovernment Interoperability Framework	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Published 2024-07-19
MOSIP open-source identity platform	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Fayda is the reference deployment (2026-07)
National Livestock Data Standards	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Endorsed and cascaded 2026-07-29

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Makatet refugee-inclusion framework	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Framework adopted 2026-07-16

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Identity mandate for school enrolment and examinations	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Mandated 2025-11-12

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Remote account opening on the digital identity	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Live 2026-04-07

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
AI service bundles in the mobile-money app	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2026-07-22

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Digital ID Assessment as official monitoring	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Re-run 2026-05-12

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Addis Ababa one-stop digital service centres	IMPLEMENTED, ON THE CITY ADMINISTRATION'S OWN ACCOUNT ↗	11 centres and more than 150 services at fiscal-year close (2026-07)

Faydaverse was inaugurated on 2026-08-04 as a state-owned enterprise under Ethiopian Investment Holdings, mandated to develop, operate and scale digital public infrastructure, with the National ID Program's executive director since 2021 as chief executive. The programme reports over 190m authentications performed and 150 enterprises integrated for biometric checks, on its own figures.

Ethio Telecom alone accounts for 69% of all registrations — about 32m citizens since April 2024. No account held states its custody or consent terms.

MESOB's own executives describe it as a front door onto unreformed back offices; a national data exchange platform is only now approved. The Auditor General credited the federal e-procurement system with a decline in cash shortages, while the same report found budget-execution gaps, billions of Birr uncollected and repeated financial-rule violations across the 163 institutions audited.

Below the federal tier the base holds little: the Addis Ababa city administration reports 11 one-stop centres carrying more than 150 services at fiscal-year close, on its own account, with no volumes, cost or evaluation published.

Telebirr moves about 11bn Birr a day across 60.6m users. The October 2025 switch integration linked M-PESA to more than 30 banks and wallets, and its parent reports 2.58m monthly active users and 89,877 registered merchants for the quarter to June 2026, about 2% of Safaricom Ethiopia's service revenue.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Berne Convention accession	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Draft ratification proclamation before the Council of Ministers, reported 2026-08-01
Copyright Proclamation 410/2004 online-infringement amendment	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Drafting with Addis Ababa University School of Law reported 2026-08-01, after several consultation rounds
Critical Infrastructure Cybersecurity Proclamation No. 1426/2026	IMPLEMENTED, WITH A TRANSITION PERIOD BEFORE FULL COMPLIANCE ↗	Signed by President Taye Atske Selassie at Addis Ababa 2026-07-21; art.28 sets commencement one year after gazettment (about July 2027)
Judicial review of licence revocation without court order	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Federal High Court of Lideta ruling 2026-06-22
Prohibition of virtual assets	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Public notice widened the prohibition 2026-07-23
Tax assessment of payment gateways	IMPLEMENTED ↗	ETB 818m swept from frozen accounts (2026-05)

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Digital Ethiopia 2030	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Published 2025-12-21
National Artificial Intelligence Policy	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Adopted 2024
National Data Governance Strategy	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Anchored in use cases from 2026-03-04
National Digital Transformation Council	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Measurement claim restated 2026-07-30

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Digital identity cooperation with Zambia	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Agreed 2026-03-24
Digital public infrastructure export to Mozambique	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Three-year memorandum signed at Addis Ababa 2026-04-27

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Data sharing arrangement under the health memorandum	PLANNED ↗	Provided for at 2.5.2, still to be negotiated
Development Bank of Ethiopia Information Disclosure Policy	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Policy adopted classifying client credit information, legal case files, strategy papers, security protocols and third-party contracts as permanently non-disclosable, reported 2026-08-08
Personal Data Protection Proclamation 1321/2024	IMPLEMENTED ↗	In force from 2024-07-24
Secondary directives under the data-protection law	NOT HELD	—

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
World Artificial Intelligence Cooperation Organization membership	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Founding member 2026-07-20

Proclamation 1321/2024 designates the Ethiopian Communications Authority as regulator. A year on, the secondary directives were unissued, public awareness was low and the Authority had yet to enforce – while the identity system it would supervise authenticates about 4m times a day. The America First Global Health Strategy memorandum of 23 December 2025 provides for a [data sharing arrangement to be negotiated](#), expected to run two years beyond its five-year term and to be compatible with Ethiopia's other agreements; no text is published.

The Development Bank of Ethiopia has moved in the opposite direction on disclosure. Under a new [Information Disclosure Policy adopted as part of a wider reform push led by president Esayas Kassa and Ethiopian Investment Holdings chair Brook Taye](#), client credit information joins internal strategy papers, legal case files, security protocols and third-party contracts as permanently exempt from declassification on the ground that disclosure could cause substantial harm to the bank, its stakeholders or national interest; the bank has also gained the right to refuse requests that would require it to create records it does not already hold.

[Critical Infrastructure Cybersecurity Proclamation No. 1426/2026 was signed by President Taye Atske Selassie at Addis Ababa on 21 July 2026](#), after unanimous ratification by the House of People's Representatives, and the Information Network Security Administration presented it publicly on 7 August. It designates 12 critical sectors, places 18 core obligations on owners and operators, and establishes a Critical Infrastructure Cybersecurity Fund. Article 28 sets commencement one year after gazettment, about July 2027, and gives the Council of Ministers and INSA regulation-making powers under articles 26 and 27.

The central bank [widened its prohibition on virtual assets](#) to the whole category by clarification rather than by new rule, with no enforcement mechanism announced. Payment gateways are being [taxed on an arithmetic error the central bank has admitted](#): gross transaction volume was conflated with gateway revenue. Corrected datasets from April 2026 were not accepted; ETB 818m was swept from frozen accounts in May against a liability counsel puts at ETB 20–30m. In June 2026 the Federal High Court of Lideta struck down a decree cutting banking services to betting platforms and gateways, finding licence revocation without a court order unconstitutional.

The Intellectual Property Authority said on 2026-08-01 that amendments to Copyright Proclamation 410/2004, prepared with the Addis Ababa University School of Law, [would define internet service provider duties, set procedures for blocking infringing sites and add a rights-holder take-down notice](#); no draft text or timetable is published. A draft proclamation ratifying the Berne Convention was before the Council of Ministers on the same date, Ethiopia not yet being a party.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Ethiopian Artificial Intelligence Institute	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Established 2020

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Vodacom change of control over Safaricom	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Completed 2026-06-30

Gulf/UAE activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Gulf digital cooperation	NOT HELD	—

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
AI University Innovation Pod	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Opened 2026-02-19
Artificial Intelligence University construction	PLANNED ↗	ETB 5bn appropriated in the FY2026/27 budget

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Ethio Telecom public share offer	IMPLEMENTED ↗	10% offer, deadline extended to 2025-02-14

The Artificial Intelligence Institute has existed since 2020, a National Artificial Intelligence Policy was adopted in 2024, and the Institute built the state's flagship service platform.

The FY2026/27 federal budget carries *Artificial Intelligence University Construction* as a single named capital project at ETB 5,000,000,000 — an appropriation large enough to dominate the year's digital total, made from domestic revenue rather than donor finance.

DeepSeek accounts for about 20% of chatbot usage in Ethiopia, the top of its 11–14% range across Africa, on affordability and Belt-and-Road infrastructure. Ethiopia is a founding member of a Chinese-led AI governance body, and the vendor in scoping talks for the enterprise AI layer also supplies the radio network.

The commercial layer is thin and domestic: the engineering-services sector is young, and nothing in the base records a private Ethiopian AI product at national scale.

Inclusion and capacity

The base holds no inclusion and capacity rows for Ethiopia. A thin evidence base is a finding, not a gap in this document.

Mobile connections reached 93.2m at 68.4% of population in late 2025, up from 85.4m and 63.8% early that year. The rural mobile-internet gender gap runs at 81% against 29% in urban areas.

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Digitally enabled pluralistic extension services programme (FAO)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Committed 2026-07-31
World Bank Digital ID for Inclusion Project	IMPLEMENTED ↗	US\$350m approved 2023-12-13

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Federal appropriation for digital transformation	IMPLEMENTED ↗	FY2026/27 budget ratified 2026-07-07
Published budget execution for FY2025/26	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Mid-year review for 2025/26 published (2026-04)
Audit of digital spending for any in-scope year	NOT HELD	—

Thirty-four budget lines across three fiscal years show ETB 1.21bn appropriated in FY2024/25 against an outturn of ETB 1.53bn, then ETB 3.75bn and ETB 9.05bn. The rise is largely the birr float rather than real growth, and the FY2026/27 figure is dominated by one capital line. Execution is published in aggregate: the Ministry of Finance's mid-year review for 2025/26 reports ETB 704.7bn mobilised over July to December 2025, 48.1% of the annual target, against ETB 798.2bn spent, 48.3% of the approved budget; no digital line is broken out, and direct budget support from development partners ran at ETB 67.8bn, 28.8% of the ETB 235.5bn projected. No audit is available for any year in scope: the Auditor General presented an EFY 2017 report to parliament in July 2026 and has not published it.

Gaps to fill

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Third mobile network operator licence	An Ethiopian Communications Authority licensing round, tender or ministerial decision on a third full operator licence.	2026-08-04
Secondary directives under the data-protection law	Directives issued by the Ethiopian Communications Authority under Proclamation 1321/2024, or a first enforcement action taken under it.	2026-08-04
Gulf digital cooperation	An MoU, investment or ministerial readout naming a Gulf state counterparty in Ethiopian digital infrastructure, AI or payments.	2026-08-04
Audit of digital spending for any in-scope year	An Office of the Federal Auditor General report for EFY 2017 or later; its published library stops at EFY 2016.	2026-08-04

Four subjects carry no reliable statement of position, and each was probed on 2026-08-04.

Two are absences that stand, dated. No secondary directive has been issued under the data-protection law. And no Ethiopia-specific Gulf digital instrument surfaced, against a large regional literature on Gulf AI investment.

The other two turn on things that exist and are not public. A third operator has a framework and no award: the licensing directive sets the route, a qualification round was launched in 2023 and paused, and nothing has been issued since. The Office of the Federal Auditor General [presented its EFY 2017 annual audit report to parliament](#) in July 2026 and has not published it, so no audit of digital spending is available for any year in scope.

Nothing from a probe is written in: a probe result reaches the base only through ingest.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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